

# Dr Jonathon Alexis Coates

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I lead global open-science and research-culture programmes and have done so for ten years across nonprofits, universities, and international collaborations. At ASAPbio I set the 2025–27 strategy which secured \$300,000 in funding; I have trained over 300 researchers, published two corresponding-author papers on preprint quality, and served as an expert source for the BBC and The Economist.

## Relevant experience

Senior Training Officer (2026 - Present)

UK Biobank

- Established a new researcher training team within the organisation, including securing £26,000 for a dedicated training platform and designing a 3 year strategy
- Line-managed the team's first training officer; brokered the first joint training workflow between training and community, replacing ad hoc requests with a shared process

Associate Director (2023 - 2025)

ASAPBio

- Developed and implemented strategic initiatives, including devising the 2025-27 direction of ASAPbio & all community initiatives, resulting in >\$300,000 secured in funding for 2026
- Independently designed and led the community strategy, leading to a record breaking year for ASAPbio with a 330% increase in engagement, 51% increase in newsletter subscriptions and a 64% increase in fellows applications all within a \$10k budget
- Consolidated ASAPbio's scattered community programmes into a single core offering, which became the foundation for the 2025–27 strategy
- Recruited, trained and mentored over 100 international ASAPbio Fellows and other researchers in open science practices to highly positive feedback
- Designed multi-format communication materials and strategy (video, social media, writing), including ASAPbio's most-viewed and engaged with YouTube content
- Provided leadership to the wider open science and metascience communities, building partnerships and collaborating with researchers, funders, institutions and publishers, resulting in a significant expansion across Africa

Executive Director (2020 - Present)

Rippling Ideas

- Founded and lead an independent [initiative](#) focused on open science, research culture, trust in research and science communication. Incorporated in September 2025.
- Designed and delivered international training, advocacy, and engagement programmes to 200+ people
- Delivered 40+ invited talks to a variety of stakeholders, including chairing panel sessions
- Authored 18+ opinion pieces ([The Scientist](#), [The Conversation](#)) and served as an expert source for the [BBC](#), [The Economist](#), [Popular Science](#), [German](#) and [Austrian](#) National radio
- Led an international metascience collaboration on preprint quality, publishing two senior-author papers (PLOS Biology [2021](#), [2022](#)) that drew [media coverage](#) across 40 outlets including Nature and The Economist
- Built and developed a [podcast](#) promoting open science and underrepresented voices; reaching the top 20 charts across 11 countries between 2021-2026
- Led a remote editorial team of five across production, outreach, and strategy for five years

- Created and grew a 450+ member [community](#) for UK/EU postdocs, recognised by the UK's national research funder as a valuable community building initiative (2020-2023)
- Built international relationships with partners in open science, including the Africa Reproducibility Network

BHF Postdoctoral Research Scientist (2020 - 2023)      Queen Mary, University of London

- Led a three-year British Heart Foundation-funded research project end to end, from experimental design through analysis to publication
- Presented at invited talks across the UK to disseminate the outcomes of research to scientific audiences and on panels discussing the importance of open science
- Supervised 7 early career researchers, ensuring successful dissertations and training in academic skills

Postdoctoral Research Scientist (2019 - 2020)      Babraham Institute, University of Cambridge

- Established and developed techniques new to the lab and wrote all lab-associated SOPs
- Appointed Postdoctoral Associate at Hughes Hall College, serving on the post-doc committee

PhD researcher (2015 - 2019)      University of Sheffield

- [Uncovered](#) the existence of macrophage subtypes in *Drosophila* and demonstrated functional differences between the populations
- Collaborated with other group members on additional projects and [publications](#)
- Chaired the department PhD student committee, which included organising a seminar series, 2-day scientific retreat (for ~100 people) and team management
- Project and team lead for the 2016-17 Sheffield iGEM entry; Co-developed the project and designed the experimental plan with a £50,000 budget. Independently led the project for its duration, training and managing a team of 17 (10 undergraduates, 5 PhD students and 2 postdocs). Awarded a gold medal and nominated for best diagnostic project
- Received the first Ian Peake award for positive contributions to the department reputation

### Other Communication & Public Engagement

**Public engagement:** I'm a Scientist (2022), Researchers night (2016-2018), Our Immune Army (2017), Festival of Life (2016-2017), International radio appearances, 6 podcast appearances, various contributions to news pieces (incl. [Nature](#), [The Economist](#), [Popular Science](#)), Video [primer](#) on preprints for UKRN (2022)

**Teaching:** Open Science Training (2023-), Research student supervision (2018, 2021-2023), [Preprints in Life Sciences Syllabus](#) (2021), Lab demonstrating (2018), A-level Biology (2012, 2014-2015)

**Scientific Advisory Boards:** EMBL-EBI Europe PMC (2022-2026), eRxiv (2024-2025), AREN (2024-)

**Board of directors:** eRxiv (2026-)

### Education

|       |           |                                                                                                                       |
|-------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ph.D. | 2015-2019 | <b>Immunology &amp; Molecular biology</b> , University of Sheffield                                                   |
| MRes  | 2014-2015 | <b>Immunobiology (Distinction)</b> , Newcastle University                                                             |
| B.Sc. | 2010-2013 | <b>Biomedical Science (1st)</b> , University of Northumbria. Awarded Dean's list for outstanding academic achievement |